Muzi Tame User Manual

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Muzi Tame v0.5 is an automatic resonance suppressor: it finds harsh, ringing or boxy frequencies as they happen and turns them down only while they stick out.

Quick start

Insert Muzi Tame, pick a preset close to your job, then shape it with Depth and the range handles while switching Delta on and off.

1. Insert Muzi Tame on a track or bus, after corrective EQ and before compression or saturation.
2. Choose a preset from the menu at the top, or start from Default.
3. Drag the gold LOW and HIGH handles in the display around the area that sounds harsh, boxy or ringing.
4. Turn on DELTA to hear only what is being removed. You should hear thin, whistly resonances, not the body of the sound. Turn it off again.
5. Raise or lower DEPTH until the problem is gone, then use OUTPUT to match the level and compare with the bypass button.

The interface at a glance

The window has three parts: a header bar, a live display, and four control panels.



Header bar

- Preset menu with arrows to step through factory presets.
- STANDARD / HI-RES: the analysis mode (see Modes and latency).
- DELTA: hear only what is being removed.
- Power button: bypass. Latency is kept while bypassed, so comparisons stay in time.

Display

- Grey fill: the spectrum of your incoming audio. Thin light line: the spectrum after processing.
- Teal curve: the total cut being applied right now, read against the dB scale on the right (0 to −18 dB).
- Teal dots: each moving tracker that is actively cutting, sitting on the resonance it follows.
- Gold curve: the broad layer, a slow and gentle tonal balance.
- Gold LOW and HIGH handles: the frequency range Muzi Tame works in. The darker area outside them is left alone.
- Hover anywhere to read the frequency and the cut at that point.

Control panels

- DYNAMICS: Attack, Release and Punch.
- TAME: Threshold, Depth (the large knob) and Sharpness.
- CHARACTER: Broad, Tonal Guard and Max Cut.
- OUTPUT: Mix, Output trim and the IN/OUT level meters.

Double-click any knob or range handle to return it to its default. Drag the bottom-right corner to resize the window.

Controls reference

Depth, Threshold and the range handles do most of the work; the rest refine how the cuts behave.

Control	Range	Default	What it does
Depth	0–200 %	100 %	How hard resonances are cut. 100 % is the calibrated amount; go higher for heavier taming.
Threshold	−6 to +12 dB	2 dB	How far a peak must rise above its surroundings before it is cut. Lower catches more.
Sharpness	4–40	12	Width of each moving cut. Higher is narrower and more surgical; lower is broader and smoother.
Attack	0.5–50 ms	3 ms	How quickly a cut engages once a resonance appears.
Release	10–500 ms	60 ms	How quickly a cut lets go after the resonance fades.
Punch	0–100 %	50 %	Eases every cut for the moment a drum hit or pluck passes, so transients keep their snap. Works above about 250 Hz.
Broad	0–100 %	30 %	Amount of the slow, wide tonal-balance layer (gold curve). It only ever cuts.

Control	Range	Default	What it does
Tonal Guard	0–100 %	80 %	Protects musical notes (melodies, chords, harmonics and bass notes) so only real resonances are cut. Lower it to chase moving or on-and-off resonances harder.
Max Cut	3–24 dB	12 dB	The deepest any single cut may go.
Mix	0–100 %	100 %	Blend of processed and original signal.
Output	−12 to +12 dB	0 dB	Output trim, for level-matched comparison with bypass.
Low Limit	20 Hz–20 kHz	20 Hz	Lower edge of the working range (LOW handle).
High Limit	20 Hz–20 kHz	20 kHz	Upper edge of the working range (HIGH handle).
Mode	Standard, High-res	Standard	Analysis resolution and latency.
Delta	on / off	off	Outputs only what is being removed.
Bypass	on / off	off	Passes the input through unprocessed, still delayed by the latency.

Cuts fade out over a third of an octave beyond each range handle, so there is no hard edge.

Modes and latency

Use Standard while recording or when delay matters; use High-res for mixing and mastering, where your DAW compensates for the delay.

Muzi Tame has to hear a resonance before it can cut it. It delays the audio slightly and uses that time to look ahead, so cuts are ready when the resonance arrives. More delay means faster, more precise cuts.

	Standard	High-res
Latency at 48 kHz	1536 samples (32 ms)	4352 samples (91 ms)
Time for a cut to reach full depth	about 29 ms	about 8 ms
Low-frequency detail	Good	Finer
Best for	Tracking, live use, everyday mixing	Mixing and mastering

Steady resonances are treated the same in both modes. The difference shows on sudden ones: in Standard, the first few tens of milliseconds of a sharp new resonance pass before the cut fully lands.

Muzi Tame reports its latency to the host, so most DAWs keep everything in time automatically. Switching modes changes the latency, which some hosts only pick up after playback is stopped and restarted.

Factory presets

Eight presets give a starting point for common jobs; they were tuned on test signals, so adjust Depth and the range by ear on your material.

Preset	Use it for	Range	Depth	Character
Default	Anything; a neutral start	20 Hz–20 kHz	100 %	Balanced
Vocal - De-Harsh	Sibilance-adjacent harshness, nasal edge	1.5–12 kHz	120 %	Fast, slightly narrow
Vocal - Body & Boxiness	Boxy, honky or muddy vocals	150 Hz–1.5 kHz	90 %	Smoother, more broad layer
Acoustic Guitar	Body boom and pick ring	200 Hz–8 kHz	100 %	Strong harmonic protection
Drum Bus - Ring Control	Snare and tom ring, room tones	150 Hz–6 kHz	130 %	Very fast, narrow cuts

Preset	Use it for	Range	Depth	Character
Mix Bus - Polish	Gentle smoothing across a mix	Full range	60 %	Slow, wide, max 6 dB
Mastering - Gentle	Final, transparent touch	Full range	40 %	Slowest, max 4 dB
Aggressive	Problem recordings, sound design	Full range	180 %	Fast, deep, max 18 dB

Presets also appear in your DAW's program list.

Workflow tips

Narrow the range to the problem, judge with Delta, and stop as soon as the problem is gone: over-taming makes sources dull and flat.

General

- Place it before compression: a compressor reacts to resonant peaks, so taming them first lets it work more evenly.
- Use Delta often. If you hear the main tone of the instrument rather than thin ringing, lower Depth or raise Threshold.
- Level-match with Output before judging against bypass; louder almost always sounds better.
- If a sung or played note sounds hollow, raise Tonal Guard.

Vocals

- Harshness lives roughly between 2 and 8 kHz; boxiness between 300 Hz and 1 kHz. Start from the matching vocal preset.
- Keep Attack fast (1–5 ms) for harsh consonants; a longer Release (80–150 ms) keeps the result smooth.
- Use a de-esser for true sibilance; Muzi Tame is for the harshness around it.

Guitars

- Acoustic: tame body boom low and pick ring high in separate instances if they need different settings.
- Distorted electric: a narrow range around 2–5 kHz with moderate Depth removes fizz without losing bite.

Drums

- Snare and tom ring are steady tones, so higher Sharpness and fast Attack work well.
- On overheads, keep the range above about 3 kHz to smooth cymbal harshness without touching the kit's body.

Mix bus and mastering

- Use low Depth (30–60 %), slow Attack and Release, and a Max Cut of 4–6 dB.
- Switch to High-res: the extra latency does not matter here, and cuts are faster and more precise.

Installation

Muzi Tame v0.4 is distributed as source and built with two commands; the build downloads JUCE 8.0.4 automatically.

You need macOS with the Xcode command-line tools (`xcode-select --install`) and CMake 3.22 or newer.

1. Unzip `MuziTame-v0.4.zip` and open Terminal in the `muzi_tame` folder.
2. Run `cmake -B build -DCMAKE_BUILD_TYPE=Release` .
3. Run `cmake --build build --config Release -j8` .
4. Copy `build/MuziTame_artefacts/Release/VST3/Muzi Tame.vst3` to `~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3/` .
5. Copy `build/MuziTame_artefacts/Release/AU/Muzi Tame.component` to `~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components/` .
6. Rescan plug-ins in your DAW. Muzi Tame appears under the manufacturer Muzi.

A standalone app is also built, in `build/MuziTame_artefacts/Release/Standalone/` , for quick tests without a DAW.

Troubleshooting and FAQ

I can barely hear a difference. On well-recorded material that is expected at default settings. Use Delta to confirm it is working, lower Threshold, or raise Depth.

It sounds dull or thin. Depth is too high or the range is too wide. Lower Depth, narrow the range to the problem area, and raise Tonal Guard on pitched sources.

A low, ringing resonance is only lightly cut. v0.5 analyses the low end with a longer window and catches narrow bass resonances better than before, but cuts there stay gentle so bass notes and kicks are not reshaped. Switch to High-res for finer low-end detail, or use a static EQ notch for a stubborn room mode.

An on-and-off or moving resonance isn't cut enough. Tonal Guard treats peaks that come and go or move around as possibly musical. Lower Tonal Guard, or narrow the range around the problem.

A melody or chord sounds thinner. Raise Tonal Guard, or narrow the range so it excludes the melody's register.

My track is out of time with the others. Make sure delay compensation is on in your DAW. After switching modes, stop and restart playback so the host picks up the new latency.

Bypass sounds quieter or louder. Bypass removes the processing and the Output trim. Level-match with Output before comparing.

CPU use is high. Each stereo instance uses about 18 % of one x86 core on the test machine (the macOS build uses Apple's vDSP and should be lighter). Use it on buses rather than many individual tracks, or freeze tracks once settled.

My older session loads differently. Controls added since it was saved open at their defaults (Punch at 50 %). Tonal Guard is smarter in v0.5, so the same settings cut melodies and chords less than before.

Specifications

Item	Value
Version	0.5.0
Formats	VST3, AU, Standalone (macOS); VST3 and Standalone on Linux
Channels	Mono or stereo, linked detection on the mid signal
Sample rates	44.1–96 kHz; analysis scales with the rate
Latency at 48 kHz	Standard 1536 samples (32 ms); High-res 4352 samples (91 ms)

Item	Value
Filters	32 moving narrow bells + 20 fixed broad bells, minimum phase (no pre-ringing)
Analysis	Standard 2048-point FFT every 128 samples; High-res 4096-point every 256; a 4x longer FFT for the region below 300 Hz
Detection	Running-median spectral envelope, noise-scatter threshold, multi-note pitch detection (up to 4 notes) plus a persistence check, transient detector
Window	Resizable, 720×450 to 1440×900
Measured on test signals	Planted peaks cut 2–5 dB; clean noise at most 0.03 dB; melodies, chords and pitched notes within about 0.2 dB on average (Standard)